

Introduction

Natural gas is a vital component of the world's supply of energy. It is one of the cleanest, safest, and most useful of all energy sources.

Natural gas is a combustible mixture of hydrocarbon gases. While natural gas is formed primarily of methane, it can also include ethane, propane, butane and pentane.

Natural gas is likely to play a greater role in the world energy mix given its growing resource base and its relatively low carbon emissions compared to other fossil fuels.

Natural gas, when compressed at a pressure of 250 bars, is termed as compressed natural gas (CNG).

Global Scenario

The world's natural gas reserves are estimated to be 7,360.9 trillion cubic feet (tcf). The Middle East holds 38.4% of the world's reserves, while an additional 21.4% is located in the former Soviet Union, with only 9% held in the OECD countries.

In 2011, the global natural gas production was 3,276.2 billion cubic metre (bcm), up 3.1% from 3,178.2 bcm in 2010, and consumption was 3,222.9